

Polytropic hat-trick

Y20 (2020) — English translation

Once Lord Kelvin carried out a cycle of a heat engine, the working fluid of which was one mole of an ideal gas with adiabatic index γ . The cycle consists of three polytropic processes, one of which is isobaric, and the product of the exponents of the other two polytropes 13 and 23 was equal to $n_{13}n_{23} = -1$, where 1 and 2 are the isobar points with minimum and maximum temperatures, respectively, and 3 is the intersection point of the polytrope 13 and 23. The temperature at point 3 satisfies the relation $T_3^2 = T_1T_2$. $T_1 = 100$ K, $T_2 = 400$ K, $\gamma = 1.5$.

A1	Find the work A of the gas in the cycle.	3.50
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A2	Find the efficiency η of the cycle.	1.50
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Source: <https://pho.rs/p/28>